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# Printable Meltdown Tracker

A paper meltdown log, ABC chart and weekly pattern sheet for autistic and ADHD children.

## What's in this pack

**Page 2 – Incident record:** one detailed form per meltdown, with tick-boxes for triggers, state beforehand, place, duration and what helped. **Pages 3–4 – ABC log:** a quick table for recording several incidents — what happened before (Antecedent), the Behaviour itself, and what came after (Consequence). **Page 5 – Weekly pattern sheet:** tally incidents by day and time of day to see when they cluster. **Page 6 – Review and summary:** pull a few weeks together before a school, GP or EHCP meeting.

## How to use it

Fill in a record as soon as things are calm, while details are fresh. You don't have to complete every box — partial logs still build a picture. Each evening or weekend, add tallies to the weekly sheet. Aim for two to four weeks of logging before drawing conclusions: single incidents tell you little, weeks of records tell you a lot.

## What an ABC chart is

ABC stands for Antecedent (what happened just before), Behaviour (what you saw, described factually) and Consequence (what happened afterwards, including what helped). Schools, SENCos and therapists use ABC charts because they focus on the situation around a meltdown, not on blame. Describe what you saw — 'lay on the floor and covered his ears for 10 minutes' is more useful than 'kicked off'.

## Using your logs as evidence

Regular records of frequency, duration, triggers and the support needed can help when talking to school, a GP or paediatrician, and when putting together evidence for an EHCP request or a DLA/PIP claim. Keep the originals and give copies.

A tracker helps you spot patterns; it doesn't replace professional advice. If meltdowns are becoming more frequent, longer or more intense, or involve injury, speak to your GP, health visitor or the school SENCo.

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Prefer to log on your phone? The free online tracker at helpset.uk/tracker spots patterns for you.

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# Meltdown incident record

Fill in once things are calm. Tick anything that applies — leave the rest blank.

Child's name _____ Filled in by _____

Date _____ Time started _____ Time ended _____ Intensity 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

mild severe

## A — What was happening just before?

## Possible triggers

- ☐ Transition
- ☐ Unexpected change
- ☐ Loud noise
- ☐ Crowds
- ☐ Screen time ending
- ☐ Demand / request
- ☐ Waiting
- ☐ Sensory overload
- ☐ Bright lights
- ☐ Clothing / texture
- ☐ Social situation
- ☐ Overwhelm
- ☐ Hunger / thirst
- ☐ Other: _____

## State before

- ☐ Hungry
- ☐ Tired
- ☐ Unwell
- ☐ Anxious
- ☐ Overstimulated
- ☐ Post-school
- ☐ Seemed fine

## Where

- ☐ Home
- ☐ School
- ☐ Shop / errand
- ☐ Car
- ☐ Friend / family
- ☐ Public place
- ☐ Other

## B — What happened? (describe what you saw)

## How long did it last?

- ☐ Under 5 min
- ☐ 5–15 min
- ☐ 15–30 min
- ☐ 30 min +

## C — What helped calm things?

- ☐ Quiet space
- ☐ Time alone
- ☐ Physical comfort
- ☐ Snack / drink
- ☐ Screen time
- ☐ Movement
- ☐ Waited it out
- ☐ Nothing helped
- ☐ Other: _____

## Anything else? (what happened afterwards, injuries, what to try next time)



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# ABC meltdown log

One row per incident. Describe what you saw rather than labels like 'naughty' or 'kicked off'.

Child's name _____ Week starting _____

| Date & time | Where | A — Before<br>What was happening? Possible trigger? | B — Behaviour<br>What did you see? | Intensity<br>1–10 | Length | C — After<br>What helped? What happened next? |
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# Weekly pattern sheet

Add a tally mark ( | ) for each meltdown. After a few weeks, look for the busiest boxes.

Child's name _____ Week starting _____

| | Mon | Tue | Wed | Thu | Fri | Sat | Sun | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Morning** (wake – 12) | | | | | | | | |
| **Afternoon** (12 – 3) | | | | | | | | |
| **After school** (3 – 6) | | | | | | | | |
| **Evening** (6 – bed) | | | | | | | | |
| **Night** | | | | | | | | |
| **Total** | | | | | | | | |

## Triggers this week — tally next to each

- ☐ Transition
- ☐ Unexpected change
- ☐ Noise / crowds
- ☐ Demand / request
- ☐ Screen time ending
- ☐ Waiting
- ☐ Sensory
- ☐ Social
- ☐ Tired / hungry
- ☐ Other

## What helped most this week?

## One thing to try or change next week



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# Review and summary

Fill in after 2–4 weeks of logging. Take a copy to school, GP, paediatrician or EHCP meetings.

Child's name _____ Period covered _____

| Total meltdowns | Average per week | Typical length |
|---|---|---|
| | | |

## Most common triggers

## Times and days when meltdowns cluster

## Signs that a meltdown is building (early warning signs)

## What helps — and what makes things worse

## Support my child needs during and after a meltdown (who, what, for how long)

## Questions or requests for school / professionals



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